Recalling Ratan's concern for the less privileged, Bhat mentions an instance when he and Ratan had gone out for lunch with Johann Peter Rupert, the chairman of Richemont, the Swiss-based luxury-goods company and Remgro, the South Africa-based company. They returned to their hotel by about 3.30 p.m. While everybody got busy with their next programme, Ratan quietly reached out to the chauffeur and asked him if he had had lunch. When the chauffeur replied that he did not get time, Ratan told him to first eat before resuming duty. An astounded Bhat remarks that it was not even his regular chauffeur.

Recalling the days when Ratan was at the helm of both Tata Chemicals and the group, R. Mukundan mentions how he was asked to doubly fortify the salt produced by Tata with iron and iodine. Ratan was acutely concerned about the instances of anaemia in children and particularly pregnant women, which was why he demanded this. He told Mukundan, 'We need to do this because the country requires it.'

Diogo Fernandes, who had worked with Ratan in NELCO as manager, says that Ratan has a special place in his heart for the underprivileged. When he was in charge of the company, he often came to its Andheri manufacturing unit, dressed in a simple pair of trousers and a shirt. And as soon as he arrived, he would make it a point to go to the assembly line in which the group had employed some visually challenged workers. He would talk to them and have tea with them before attending to his other duties.

Mahalingam, Ratan's chief trainer at Jamshedpur, recalls an emotional incident. Ratan had become close to Mahalingam's family during his stay in Jamshedpur. He had also become close to his son Prem, who was only sixteen and in the 'last stages' of cancer. It was during this time that the Tatas decided to open an office in Sydney, Australia, in collaboration with Dalgety.

JRD had put Ratan in charge of the office and instructed him to leave for Australia soon. Accordingly, Ratan was booked to fly directly from Bombay to Sydney. But he cancelled the flight and instead flew from Bombay to Calcutta. After reaching Calcutta, he took a Tata plane to Jamshedpur and drove straight to the hospital where Prem was admitted.

Mahalingam recalls, 'Ratan knew that if he did not see him [Prem] then, he would never see him again.' He therefore 'made a detour'.